MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | CI/CD & Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, ephemeral test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and test infrastructure serving three product teams. Hands-on experience with Docker, Helm and namespace-level Kubernetes deployments, alongside personal projects using k3s, GitOps and Terraform. Strong analytical and documentation skills, with experience leading CI/test-infrastructure improvements across three product teams, documenting workflows for onboarding, and helping QA and product teams adopt more effective testing workflows. Transitioning into a full-time DevOps / platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal projects), Argo CD
Containers & platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm deployments), k3s
Programming & scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL
Monitoring & data: Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems & tools: Linux, Git, Ansible (basic), Traefik, cert-manager, TLS certificate management
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning); Hetzner VPS

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Built a GitLab CI workflow that deploys a short-lived environment for each merge request, including the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, using Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Configured automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments for feature reviews, with end-to-end tests running against them.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled CI pipelines across three teams and parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into their own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, deploying applications from a Git repository with Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team.
- Flaky test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the most frequent failures.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams of approximately 25 developers, covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Built ephemeral test environments using Docker Compose and, subsequently, Helm charts deployed to the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Work with namespace-level access; the platform team operates the cluster.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes through parallel test jobs, dependency caching and on-demand ephemeral environments.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for seeding test data into PostgreSQL.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.
- Joined two incident calls as an observer.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications for client projects.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA): studying; exam booked for January 2027 (not yet passed)
Terraform Associate: practice tests completed; exam not taken

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)